

IT Helpdesk Ticket Volume – ITES

Context: A large IT services company has 50,000 employees across India, all using company-issued laptops and enterprise software (email, VPN, ERP, etc.).

Estimate the number of IT helpdesk tickets (hardware + software issues) raised annually across this organization. Also estimate how many support agents would be needed to handle this volume.

Let us first break down the ticket volume by issue type, since employees raise tickets at different rates depending on the category of problem. We can split this into three buckets: hardware issues (laptop malfunctions, peripherals), software issues (application errors, ERP problems, installations), and access or network issues (email, VPN, password resets).

Assume hardware issues occur at about 0.3 tickets per employee per month, software issues at about 0.6 tickets per employee per month, and access or network issues at about 0.6 tickets per employee per month, giving a blended rate of about 1.5 tickets per employee per month.

Using this, the annual ticket volume can be estimated as follows:

Hardware issues: $50,000 \times 0.3 \times 12 = 180,000$ tickets.

Software issues: $50,000 \times 0.6 \times 12 = 360,000$ tickets.

Access/network issues: $50,000 \times 0.6 \times 12 = 360,000$ tickets.

Adding these, the organization raises about 900,000 helpdesk tickets annually.

Now let us estimate the number of support agents needed to handle this volume. Assume an agent works an 8-hour day, but after breaks, internal meetings, and non-ticket work, only about 80 percent of that time (roughly 384 minutes) is spent actively resolving tickets.

Assume an average handling time of about 20 minutes per ticket (mixing quick password resets with longer hardware troubleshooting). That gives about $384 \div 20 \approx 19$ tickets resolved per agent per day.

Assuming an agent works about 250 days a year after accounting for weekends, holidays, and leave, each agent can resolve about $19 \times 250 \approx 4,750$ tickets per year.

Number of agents required = total annual tickets $\div$ tickets handled per agent per year = $900,000 \div 4,750 \approx 190$ agents.

Adding a small buffer for shift overlap, escalations to tier-2 support, and team leads, a reasonable estimate is about **190 to 210 support agents**.

So, a good final guesstimate is that the organization raises about **900,000 IT helpdesk tickets annually**, requiring roughly **200 support agents** to handle the volume.